

A Brief Note on the Next Generation of Mobile Apps

Mobile devices have become ubiquitous. In many cases, mobiles perform the work expected of a PC. Hence, there is a need for us to take a long, hard look at the next generation of mobile apps that will support personal and professional work on mobile devices.

In this era of all-pervasive technology, mobile phones are a basic personal and professional requirement. There are thousands of popular consumer mobile applications on leading mobile platform stores like Google Play, Apple Store and Windows Marketplace, while emerging and evolving innovative hardware capabilities are providing the platforms for the next generation of apps. Applications are being designed, implemented and targeted for mobile and wearable devices. There are many popular consumer and enterprise app stores with incredible user bases. Soon, mobile apps will no longer be considered just an extension of existing desktop clients or portals. There will be solutions that work only on connected devices. The consumer market will grow to command an increasing user base and there will be many new innovative mobile apps. However, the enterprise segment is also maturing to the point of adopting connected devices for day-to-day work.

Enterprise mobility

Enterprise mobility is still largely unexplored and untapped. This potential market is too big to ignore. Ubiquitous mobile and Internet usage implies unlimited opportunities in this space. A massive growth has been observed in the sale of smartphones and tablets. With capabilities like quad core processors, decent memories and bigger screen sizes, smart devices are ideal for personal and professional use. Gadgets owned by the target user — employees, partners, distributors, contractors and customers — are currently smarter than the technology options being provided by enterprises, which is a huge challenge for the latter. Organisations are trying hard to come up with an efficient, secure, and usable process that acts as a catalyst across multiple platforms to meet the expectations and demands of the target users.

Enterprise users (CEOs, CIOs, CTOs, executives, sales representatives, employees, etc) are looking for their structured or unstructured data (presentations, documents, contact details, agreements, statement of work, etc) on mobile devices, either online or offline. The users' demand for anytime, anywhere accessibility of data on a mobile is the key to next generation mobile apps.

Leading mobile platforms already provide personalisation on mobile devices. A single device can have personal as well as professional data with adequate security enforcement.

Enterprise mobility, along with solutions, products and services such as EMM (enterprise mobility management), MAM (mobile application management), MDM (mobile device management), EAS (enterprise app store), etc, is already in use in medium and large sized enterprises. So, what's next?

Polyglot persistence

Polyglot persistence (storing data on multiple data stores, either SQL or NoSQL) is becoming a need for enterprises. Enterprises can have data in various formats such as graphs, columns, key-values, tables and documents. There are many existing SQL and NoSQL data stores, each one with its own pros and cons. So it's very feasible for an enterprise to depend on multiple data sources, either SQL or NoSQL, as per a system's needs. There could even be a need to support

